

MAT282 Intermediate Statistics: Midterm Exam

Franklin University Switzerland · Fall 2026 · Instructor: Assoc. Prof. C. Burke · Oct 9, 2026

Name: _____

Form: A

Score: _____ / 50

Time: about 45 minutes · **Allowed:** pen/pencil, calculator, ruler · **Total:** 50 points · Show working for every calculation: marks are for method as well as answers. Give numerical answers to 2 decimal places unless told otherwise. The data are **synthetic teaching data** from a fictional seaside gelato café, not real records.

Scenario. A seaside café recorded daily sales and weather for 168 trading days (7 April–21 September 2025). You will work with a **13-day sample** of those days. The manager's belief: *"Hot days are good for business."* Your tasks follow the way we work in class: state ideas that can be tested, describe the data, test the relationship, compare periods, and read model output.

Operationalisation. **Temperature** = daily mean outdoor temperature (°C) during opening hours. **Gelato Units** = number of standard servings of gelato sold that day.

Part 1 · Concepts: hypothesis, falsification, data quality (8 points)

1. Hypothesis & falsification [LO 1]

[4]

The manager's belief is vague. (a) Rewrite it as a **testable hypothesis** linking temperature to gelato units, including the **direction** of the relationship and the statistic you would use. (2) (b) Describe a specific result from the 13-day sample that would **falsify** your hypothesis. (2)

2. Validity & reliability [LO 2]

[4]

(a) "Daily mean temperature during opening hours" is used to capture *how hot it felt to customers when deciding to buy gelato*. Give **one reason** this operationalisation might be a weak (invalid) measure of that idea. (2) (b) Name **one thing** that could make the temperature *or* sales measurement unreliable, and say what it would do to the data. (2)

Part 2 · Describing the data: calculation and visualisation (13 points)

Sample data (13 days). Sum of gelato units = 2431.

Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
Date	Apr 7	May 5	May 23	May 28	Jun 16	Jul 30	Aug 2	Aug 16	Aug 17	Aug 23	Aug 28	Sep 2	Sep 16
Temp (°C)	19.7	20.2	19.3	12.6	17.7	22.7	30.9	22.9	21	25.5	21.7	28.2	26.2
Gelato Units	166	225	164	111	131	134	294	193	209	198	196	194	216

3. Mean & median [LO 3]

[3]

Calculate the **mean** and **median** of gelato units. Which is the better summary of a “typical day” here, and why?

4. Quartiles & outliers [LO 3, 4]

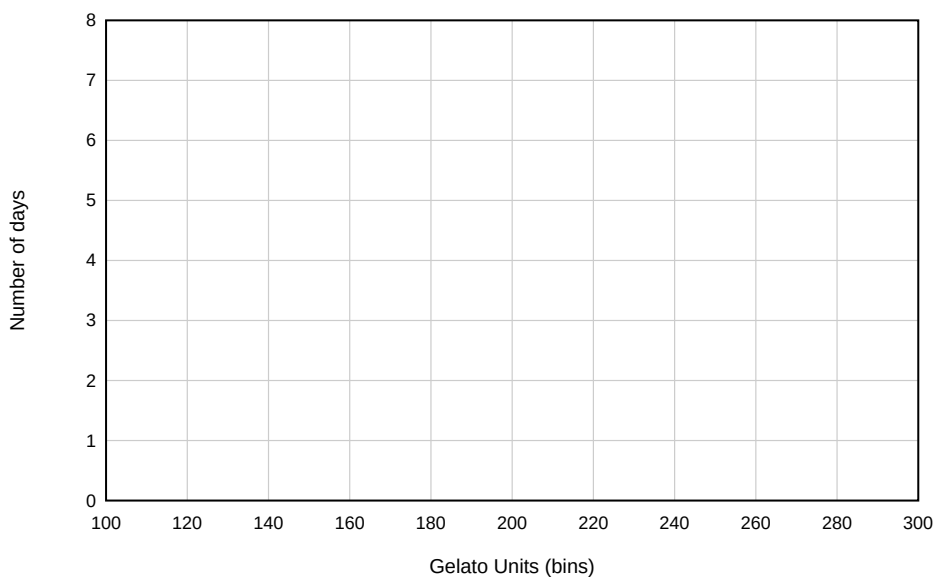
[4]

Sort the gelato units values. Using the Sheets convention for 13 values (**Q1 = 4th** and **Q3 = 10th** ordered value), find Q1, Q3 and the IQR, calculate the **1.5×IQR fences**, and state which day(s), if any, are outliers.

5. Histogram [LO 4]

[3]

Draw a **histogram** of gelato units using the bins marked on the axis (each bin includes its lower edge). Label the vertical axis as a frequency count, and then describe the **shape** in one sentence.



6. Spread & Sheets [LO 3, 5]

[3]

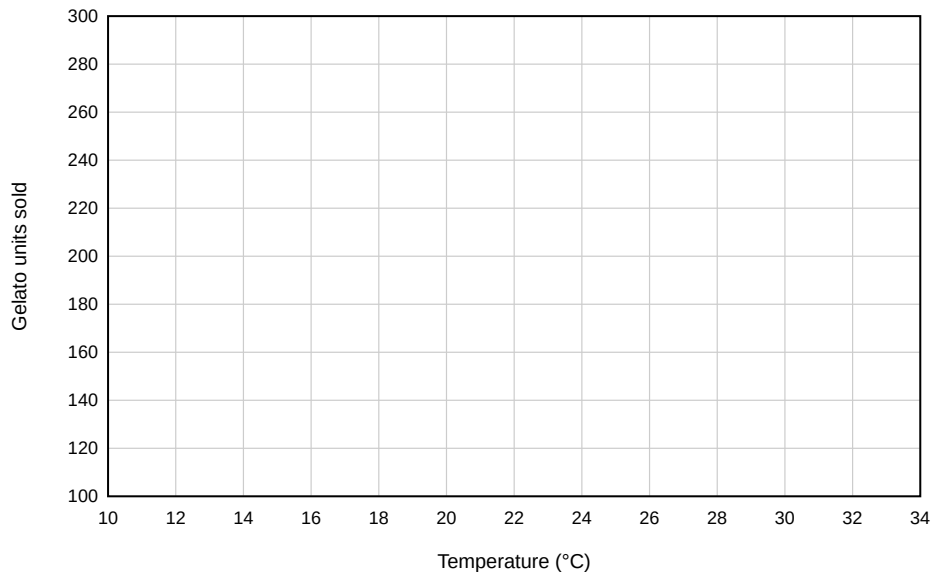
The sum of squared deviations is $\sum(y - \bar{y})^2 = 27196$. (a) Calculate the **sample standard deviation**. (2) (b) Write the Sheets formula you would use if the gelato units sit in cells C2:C14. (1)

Part 3 · Relationship and prediction (13 points)

7. Scatterplot [LO 4]

[3]

Plot the 13 days (temperature on the x-axis, gelato units on the y-axis) and draw a **line of best fit by eye**. Circle the outlier you found in Question 4.



8. Correlation [LO 3, 6]

[2]

Estimate the correlation coefficient r for your scatterplot (no calculation). Explain in one sentence what the **sign** and the **size** of r tell you.

9. Prediction & error [LO 5]

[4]

A line fitted to these data is $\hat{y} = 15.91 + 7.71 \cdot \text{temperature}$. (a) Write the Sheets formula *FORECAST* to predict gelato units for a 24 °C day, if temperatures are in B2:B14 and gelato units are in C2:C14, and calculate the prediction. (2) (b) For the two days below, calculate the residual (actual – predicted) and the **mean absolute deviation** (MAE) of the two predictions. (2)

Day	Temp	Actual
May 23	19.3	164
Aug 17	21	209

10. Interpretation & extrapolation [LO 6, 7]

[2]

(a) Interpret the slope in one sentence **in context**. (1) (b) Would you use the line to predict gelato units on a 15 °C day? Why or why not? (1)

11. Weighted average [LO 5]**[2]**

Over all 168 days, the café grouped days by temperature. Calculate the **weighted mean** of daily gelato units across the three bands, and say why it differs from the simple average of the three band means.

Band	Days (n)	Mean units
below 20 °C	34	160.8
20 to 25 °C	89	189.7
above 25 °C	45	218.1

Part 4 · Comparing periods and significance (6 points)**12. Difference of means [LO 3, 6, 7]****[6]**

On 30 June 2025 the café raised the gelato price from €4.00 to €4.50. Daily gelato sales (full data):

	Days (n)	Mean units	Std dev
Before (to 30 Jun)	85	183.2	36.3
After (from 1 Jul)	83	199.9	33.5

(a) Calculate the **standard error** of the difference in means, $SE = \sqrt{(s_1^2/n_1 + s_2^2/n_2)}$. (2) (b) Calculate $t = (\text{difference})/SE$, and decide whether the difference is statistically significant at 5% (use $|t| > 1.97$ as the cutoff). (2) (c) Is it sensible to conclude that the price change *caused* the change in sales? Give one rival explanation. (2)

Part 5 · Reading model output (LINEST) (6 points)

13. Computation: interpreting LINEST [LO 5, 6, 7]

[6]

A student fits a multiple regression for **gelato_units** on **temperature_c**, **beach_event**, **weekend** (in that column order) with =LINEST(y, X, TRUE, TRUE) on all 168 days. Sheets returns (rounded):

	Col 1	Col 2	Col 3	Col 4
Row 1	34.16	25.74	5.57	48.97
Row 2	3.85	4.27	0.52	11.86
Row 3	0.61	22.52	#N/A	#N/A
Row 4	86.39	164.00	#N/A	#N/A
Row 5	131402.67	83146.74	#N/A	#N/A

Row 1: coefficients (last X column first, intercept last) · Row 2: standard errors · Row 3: R^2 , SE of y · Row 4: F, df · Row 5: SS regression, SS residual.

(a) Which column holds the **temperature** coefficient? State its value and interpret it **holding the other variables constant**. (2)

(b) Calculate the t-statistic for **beach_event** and say whether it is significant (cutoff $|t| > 1.97$). Interpret the coefficient in plain language. (2)

(c) What does $R^2 = 0.61$ mean here? Using a simple regression with temperature alone, $R^2 = 0.34$. What does the increase suggest? (2)

Part 6 · Design your own test (4 points)

Codebook for all variables in the full data set:

Variable	Meaning / operationalisation
temperature_c	Daily mean outdoor temperature (°C) during opening hours
sunshine_hours, rainfall_mm, wind_kmh, humidity_pct	Daily weather during opening hours
beach_event	1 if an organised public event occurred on the nearby beach that day, else 0
weekend	1 if Saturday or Sunday, else 0
gelato / iced coffee / pastry price	Posted price in € for one standard serving; changed on 30 June 2025 and varied by daily price trials
gelato / iced coffee / pastry units	Number of standard servings sold that day (no stock-outs or closures)

14. *Blueprint your own analysis [LO 1, 5, 7]*

[4]

Choose **any two variables** from the codebook that we have *not* examined in this exam. In about 5 sentences, give: (i) your **hypothesis** and why you expect it; (ii) your **expected finding** (direction and rough strength); (iii) the **analysis** you would run in Sheets (columns, function or chart); (iv) a result that would **falsify** you. Creativity is welcome: reasoning matters more than being right.